Teaching Statement

Teaching Philosophy

My goal as a teacher is for students to leave my courses able to use economic reasoning and data to approach questions they care about. I want a student to be able to look at a subsidy, a price spike, or a hunger statistic and ask who gains, who pays, and what drives it.

This goal grows out of my research. I study who captures the value of clean-energy subsidies and whether firms exercise market power in electricity markets, questions that turn on a simple model and careful measurement. I teach the same way: start with an intuitive model, confront it with real data, and ask students to judge whether the model survives.

Teaching Experience

At UMass Amherst I have been the instructor of record for two undergraduate courses. I taught Managerial Economics online in the summers of 2024, 2025, and 2026, and Hunger in the Global Economy in Fall 2025. Teaching the same course three times let me redesign it each summer based on what had and had not worked the year before.

The two courses reach very different students. Managerial Economics serves students who want tools for business decisions: pricing, costs, market structure, and strategy. Hunger in the Global Economy draws students from across the university, many without an economics background, who come because they care about food insecurity and development.

Before teaching my own courses, I was a teaching assistant for Introduction to Statistics, for undergraduate Industrial Organization, and for the graduate Statistics course. Statistics is an essential toolbox but also where many students first feel lost in economics, and leading many sections of it taught me to spot where students get stuck and how to explain the same idea several ways.

In the Classroom

Three practices run through all of my courses.

Start from a real question. I open each unit with a question students can recognize, and only then introduce the theory that answers it. In Managerial Economics, one question carries the first weeks of the course: do "forever chemicals" (PFAS) in drinking water make people sick, and what should be done about it? Students act as litigation consultants preparing a class-action case. They first estimate the link between exposure and illness, then ask what clean water is worth when no market prices it, and finally whether the government should pay to clean it up. Each answer raises the next question, so regression, non-market valuation, and cost-benefit analysis arrive as tools students need rather than topics on a syllabus. In Hunger in the Global Economy, a question such as why the Irish Famine occurred under a free market leads naturally into the role of government policy.

Put data in students' hands. Students learn more from estimating a demand curve themselves than from watching me do it. In Managerial Economics, small groups plot price and quantity data in Excel, estimate linear and log-log demand, and interpret the slope as a price elasticity. In the PFAS case, students clean and merge claimant data and present their findings to the legal team as a short memo with tables and graphs, the kind of deliverable they will produce at work. I also walk students through published studies, and ask them to apply the same methods to our own data. My time leading statistics sections taught me to pair each new tool with one concrete dataset students can return to, and the PFAS data plays that role.

Make thinking visible. Rather than lecturing for a full class, I break sessions with short problems that students work in groups, then ask groups to explain their answers. Hearing a classmate's wrong answer explained, and then corrected, often clarifies more than my own explanation. I also ask students to pair up on topics rooted in real life and present their work in front of the class. For homework, I design analytical assignments in Excel, software students already have access to and will keep using after graduation. Because every step of the analysis sits in a visible cell, I can see where a student's reasoning went wrong, not just whether the final answer is right.

Inclusive Teaching

My students arrive with very different preparation, from economics majors to nutrition students taking their first social science course. I studied economics and finance in Taiwan before graduate school in Arizona and Massachusetts, so I know what it is like to learn the field in a new setting. I try to make the unwritten rules of a course explicit: what a good answer looks like, how to use office hours, and that making mistakes is a normal part of learning. In practice, this means working through examples before every problem set, offering several ways to engage, and checking in early with students who fall behind.

Teaching Interests

I am prepared to teach undergraduate courses in principles and intermediate microeconomics, managerial economics, statistics and introductory econometrics, environmental and natural resource economics, energy economics, and industrial organization.

I would especially like to develop an undergraduate course on the economics of the energy transition. It would use public data on solar adoption, electricity prices, and vehicle safety, the same data behind my research, to teach students how markets and policy shape who bears the costs of that transition.

Whether students go on to graduate school, policy jobs, or business, I want them to leave my classroom able to ask a sharp economic question, find evidence to answer it, and make careful decisions.